

CHAPTER FOUR

KUSHINA

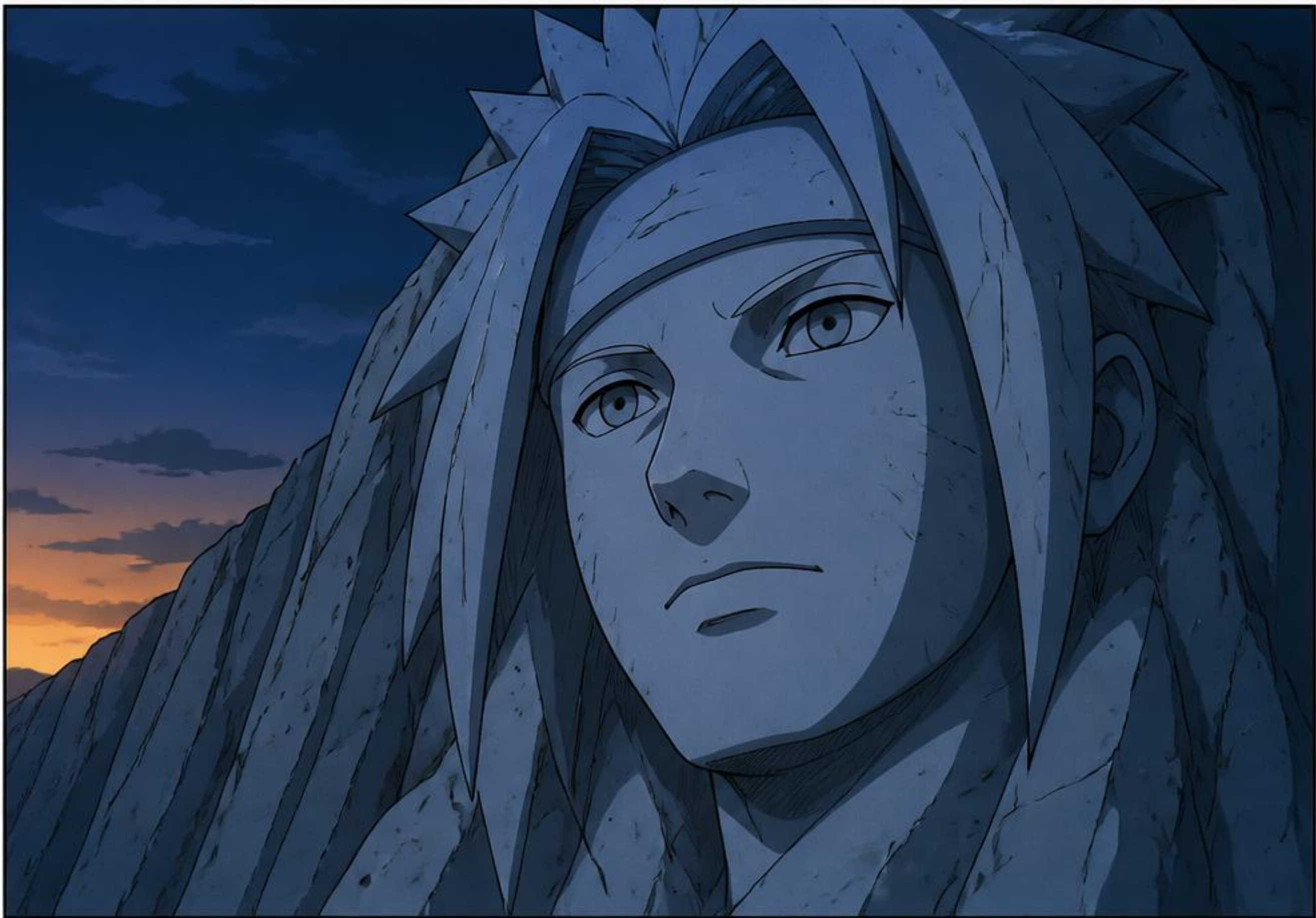
UCHIHA NARUTO: THE SAGE . VOLUME ONE

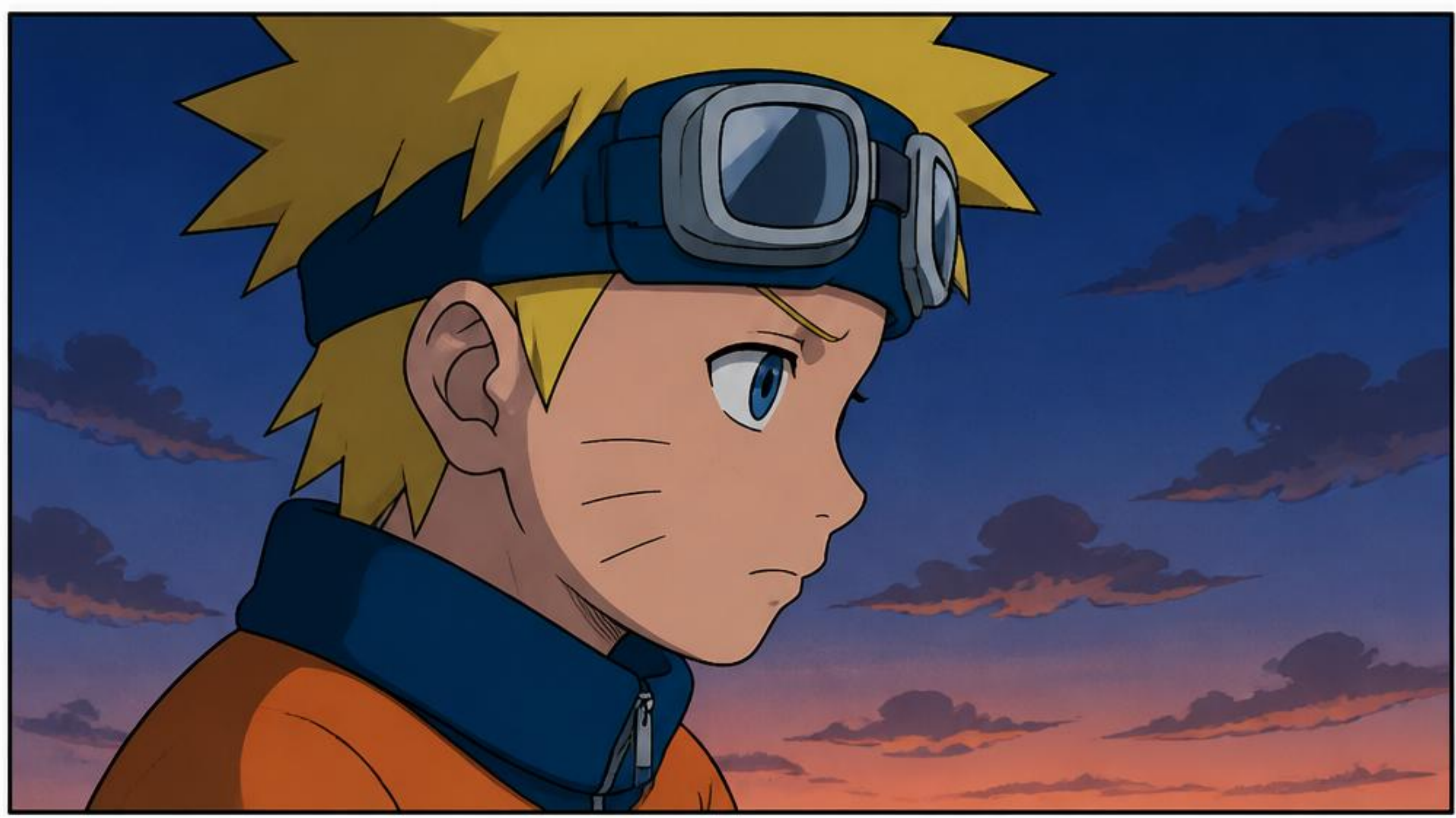














A young woman with brown hair tied in a ponytail, wearing a white headscarf and a white apron over a white shirt, stands in a kitchen. She is holding a stack of five light-colored bowls. The kitchen has wooden shelves with more bowls and a glowing orange paper lantern hanging from the ceiling. The scene is set at night, with a dark street visible through the open doorway.

Naruto! I haven't seen you in three months - where have you been?

The young woman is kneeling on the floor, hugging a young boy with spiky blonde hair and blue eyes. The boy is wearing an orange jumpsuit and a blue headband with goggles. The woman is wearing the same white headscarf and apron as in the first panel. The kitchen setting is the same, with the wooden shelves and the orange lantern visible in the background.

Don't you ever do that to me again. I was worried sick.



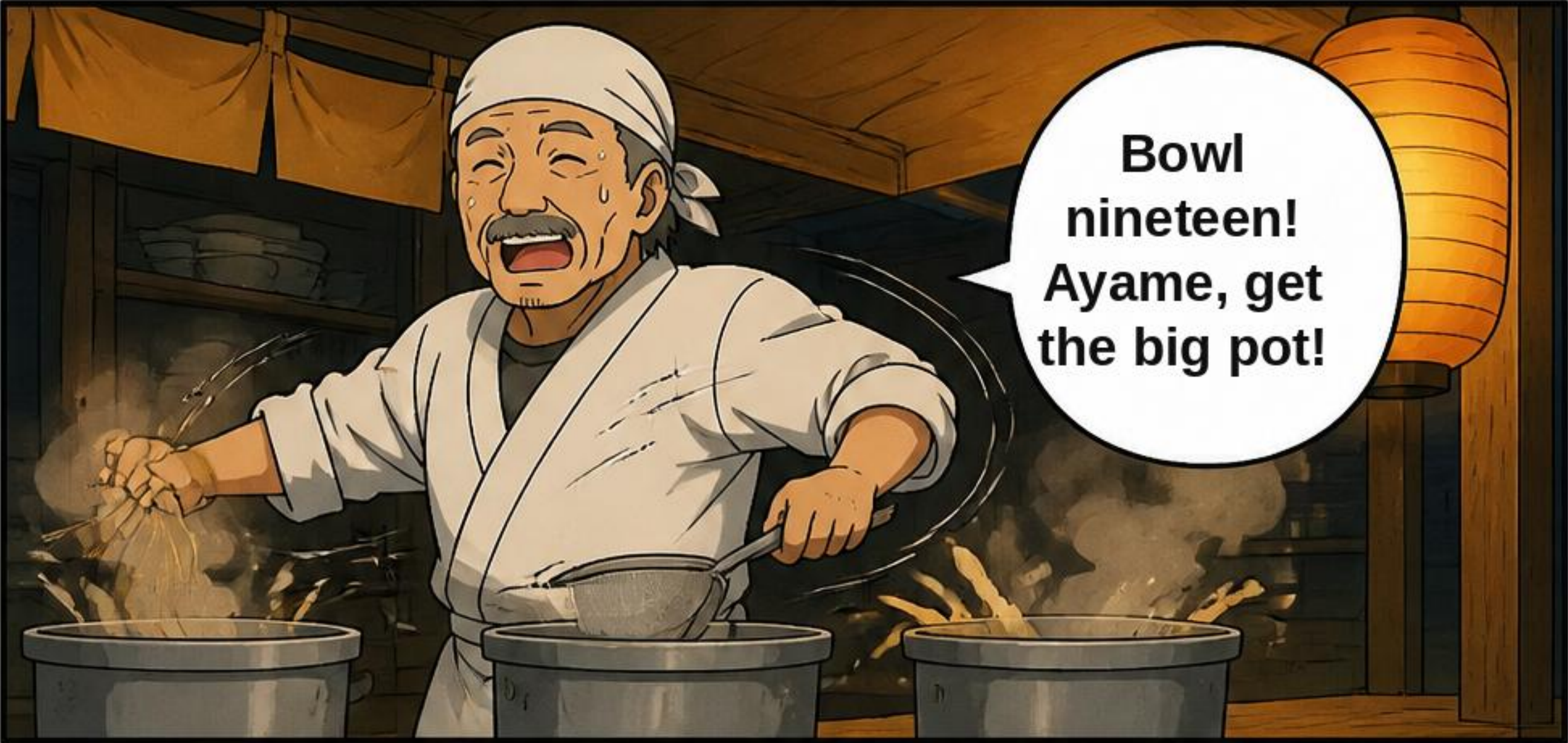
Three whole months! Then the first six bowls are on the house, kid.



Then make it twenty-six bowls of miso pork. And keep 'em coming!



Twenty... six?



A young boy with spiky blonde hair and goggles on his forehead sits at a wooden table in a dimly lit restaurant. He is wearing an orange jacket. A woman in a white chef's uniform and headscarf is leaning over the table, wiping his face with a white cloth. A bowl of ramen and a glass of water are on the table. In the background, shelves hold various bowls and a warm lantern hangs from the ceiling.

Aw, quit
it! I'm not
a baby!

An older man with a white headscarf and a mustache, wearing a white chef's uniform, sits at the counter of the restaurant. He is smiling and looking towards the woman in the white uniform who is standing with her back to him. Steam is rising from the kitchen area in the background.

Ha! Let the
boy eat like a
boy, Ayame.

A close-up shot of the young boy with blonde hair and goggles. He is looking slightly to the right with a thoughtful expression. The background shows the interior of the restaurant with wooden walls and a counter.

...Thanks,
old man.
For real.







In one of the
history books
I gave you
there was a
man called
Uchiha
Madara.



The one who
fought the
Shodaime
Hokage. The
one who lost.



I am
that
man.



...Huh.



That can't be true. Madara died fighting the Shodaime - it's in the book you gave me.



So the book says.



You read them properly, then. Good.



Since you won't believe that - how about I tell you about your parents instead.



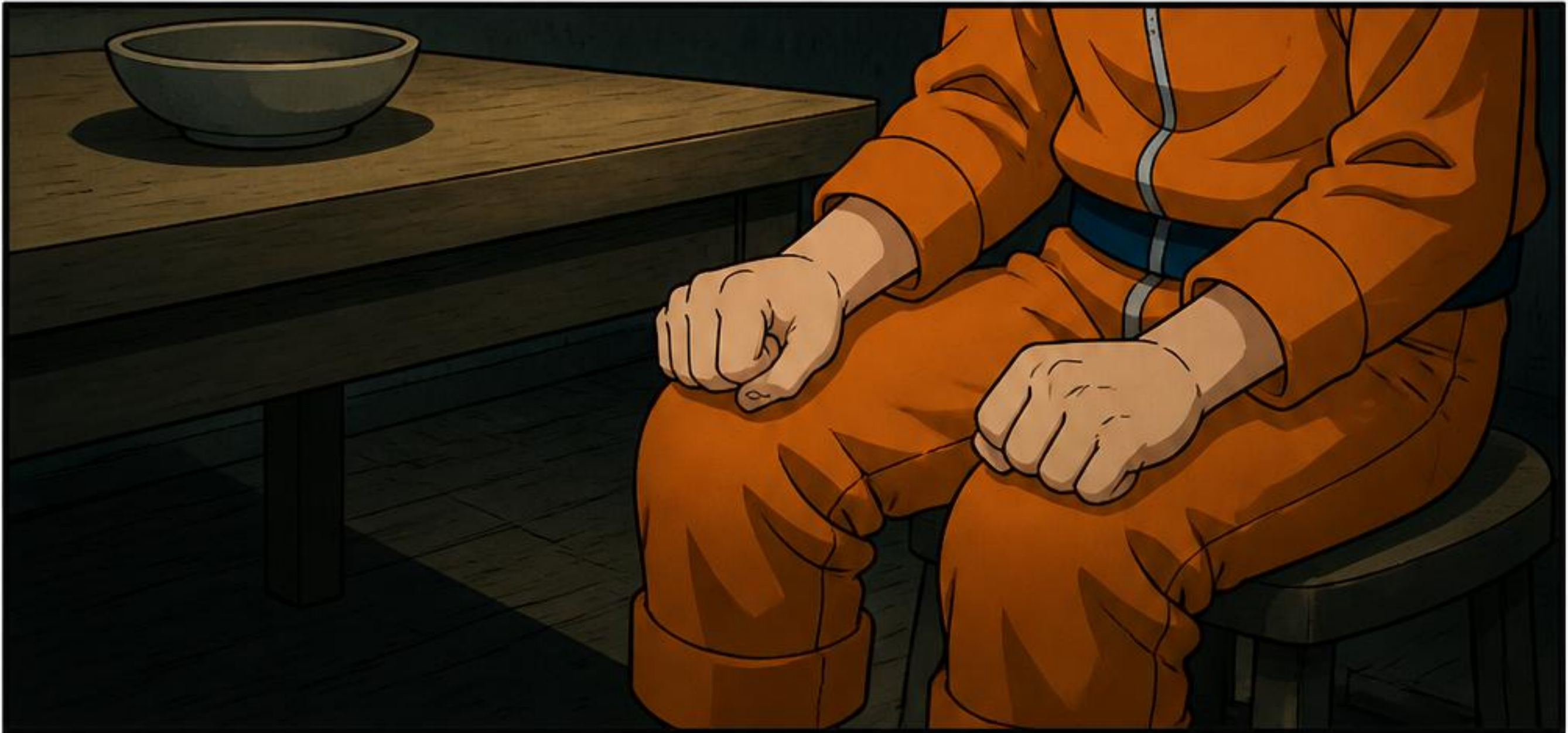


Sit. And listen carefully - I will say this only once.

Okay.



Your mother was the jinchuuriki of the Kyuubi. Before it was sealed inside you.







Her name
was
Kushina
Uzumaki.



Kushina.